

The files that control the network setup are:

`/etc/hosts`

`/etc/sysconfig/network`

`/etc/sysconfig/network-scripts/ifcfg-eth0`

The last file, `ifcfg-eth0`, contains all the details such as the IP address, Gateway address and even the MAC address of your ethernet card. The other two may not necessarily be edited for address changes. The “`/etc/hosts`” file is used for name-to-IP translation, while the “`/etc/sysconfig/network`” file contains the hostname and status of networking—“yes” or “no”.

Before you start editing any of these files, we advise you to shut down the network service. This can be done by changing or re-logging in as root and then typing “`#cd /etc/rc.d/init.d/`” followed by “`#network stop`”.

Let’s take a look at the files mentioned above. We entered a certain address for our Ethernet card, and now you can see how it was all entered into these files.

In the `etc/hosts` file, a user can add the IP address and the name of the machine. For example, if there is a machine with IP address 10.10.124.112 and the name of that computer or host is “tux”, then you can add the line:

```
“10.10.124.112          tux”
```

Now if you ping tux, `/etc/hosts` will resolve the name to its IP address and send data bytes to the address and not the name—the name behaves as an alias. You will receive a reply if the machine named tux is active on the network—that is, if the machine is on and it is present on the network.

Well, let’s not forget that we had disabled the service. So, to restart it, go back to the directory `/etc/rc.d/init.d/` and issue the command “`#network start`”.